and homochlamydeous, the three tepals of the outer whorl and the two lateral tepals of the inner whol are fused by valvate aestivation to form 5 toothed tube like structure called abaxial lip, the posterior inner median tepal is distinctly broad membrancus and free called labellum.

Androecium: Stamens 6, arranged in two whorls of 3 each, arranged opposite to the tepals. Only five stamens are fertile and the inner posterior stamen is either absent or represented by staminode. Anthers are dithecous and dehisce by vertical slits. Filament is simple and filiform and rudimentary ovary or pistillode is often present in the male flower.

Gynoecium: Tricarpellary, syncarpous, the median carpel anterior, trilocular, ovary inferior, numerous ovules on axile placentation. Style is simple and filiform, stigma trilobed.

Fruit: An elongated fleshy berry and seeds are not produced in cultivated varieties.

Floral Formula

Male flower:

$\mathbf{Br,Ebrl,\%,\male,P_{(3+2)+1},A_{3+3},G_0.}$

Female flower:

$\mathbf{Br,Ebrl,\%,\female,P_{(3+2)+1},A_0,\overline{G}_{(3)}.}$

Bisexual flower:

$\mathbf{Br,Ebrl,\%,\hermaphrodite,P_{(3+2)+1},A_{3+3},\overline{G}_{(3)}.}$

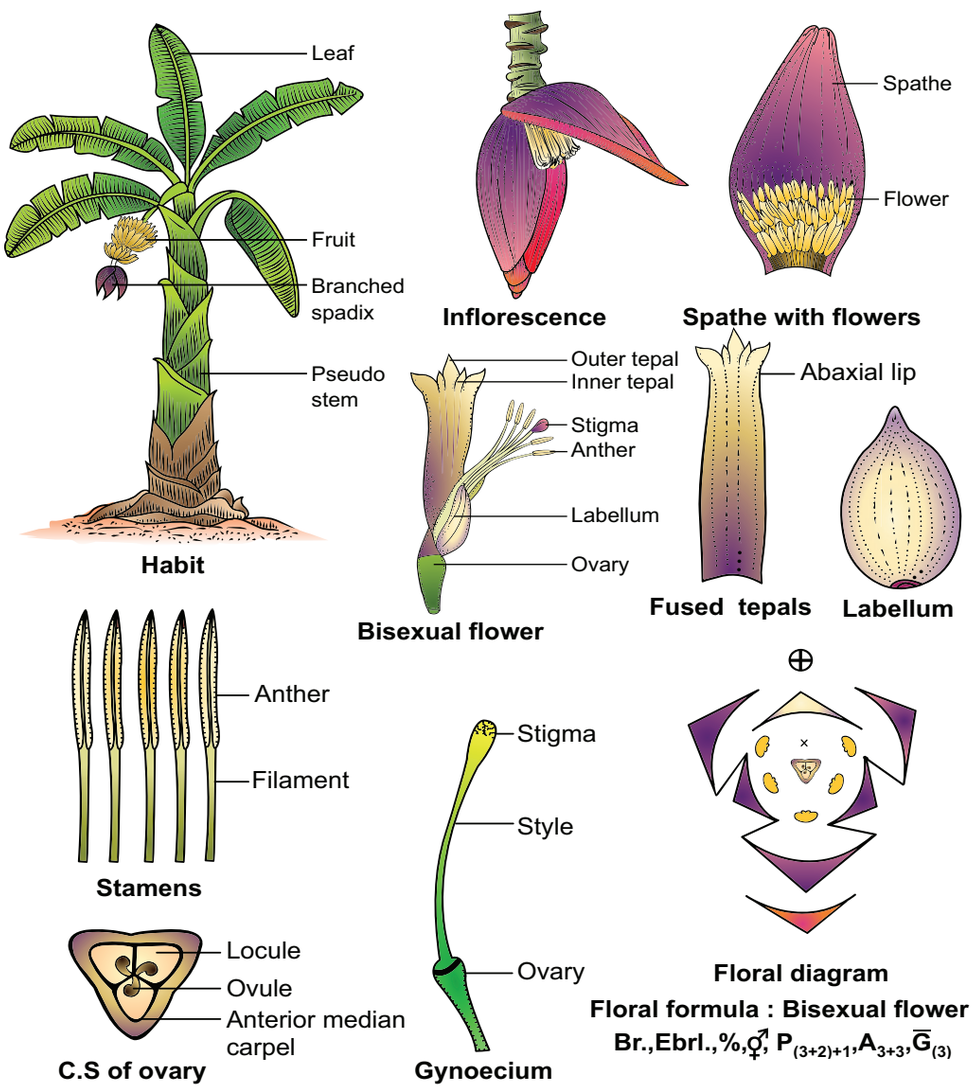


Figure 5.17: *Musa paradisiaca*

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